"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 39

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

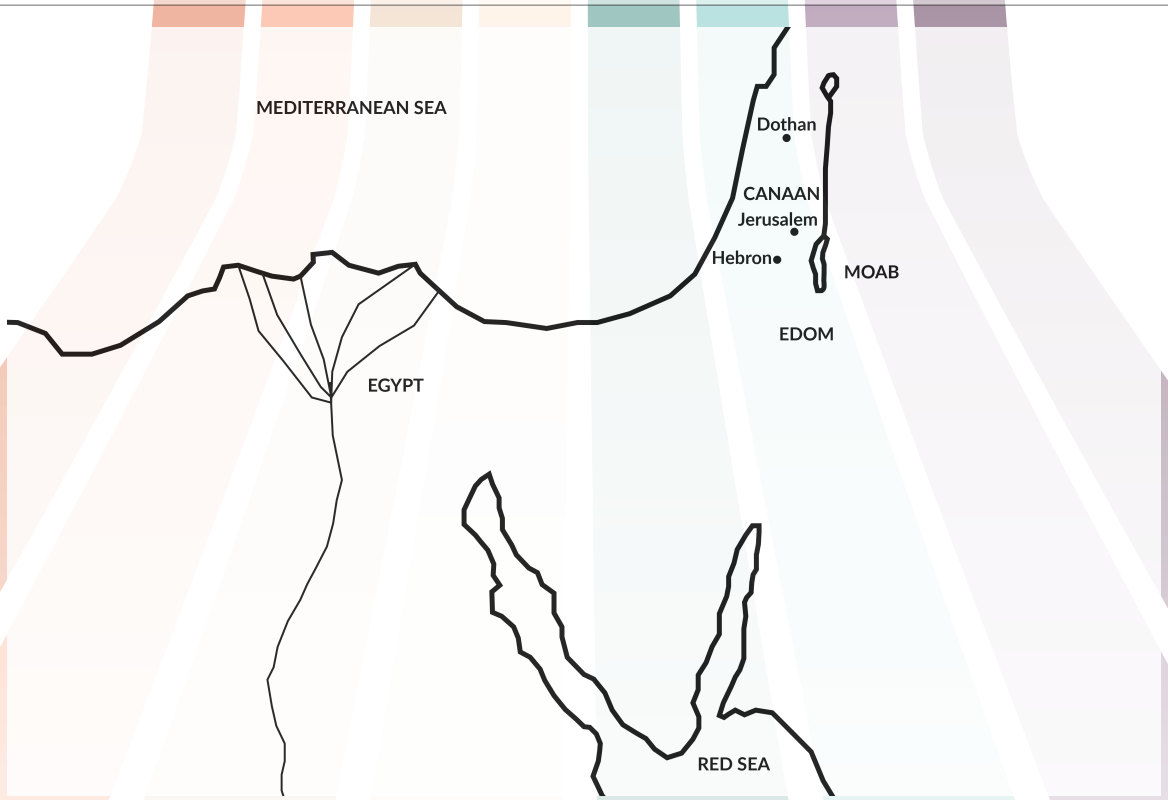
- Joseph was 17 when he went to Egypt (approximately 1728 B.C.).

Characters:

- Joseph – Jacob's son with Rachel. Joseph's brothers hated him and sold him into slavery.
- Potiphar – An officer of Pharoah, the captain of the guard.
- Potiphar's wife – She lied about Joseph and got him thrown in prison.

Where:

- The story contained in Genesis 39 took place in the country of Egypt.



Outline:

- JOSEPH IN POTIPHAR'S HOUSE (39:1-6a):
    + After Joseph's brothers sold him, he was brought to Egypt and sold again to a man named Potiphar, an officer of Pharoah.
    + Joseph served Potiphar faithfully.
    + Potiphar saw that the Lord was with Joseph, and he made him the overseer of his house and all his possessions.
    + The Lord blessed Potiphar's house because of Joseph.
- POTIPHAR'S WIFE LIES ABOUT JOSEPH (39:6b-20):
    + The text tells us Joseph was handsome in form and appearance.
    + Potiphar's wife tried to seduce Joseph, but he refused her advances.
    + He told her he would not break Potiphar's trust.
    + She tried repeatedly to seduce him, but he continued to refuse.
    + One day, when Joseph was in the house with her alone, she grabbed his garment and insisted he sleep with her.
    + Joseph ran out of the house but left his garment behind.
    + Potiphar's wife lied to her husband and told him Joseph tried to seduce her but fled without his garment when she cried out for help.
    + Potiphar was furious at Joseph and threw him into the prison where the king's prisoners were jailed.
- JOSEPH IN PRISON (39:21-23):
    + "But the Lord was with Joseph and showed him steadfast love and gave him favor in the sight of the keeper of the prison."
    + Joseph was put in charge of all the daily tasks of the prison and the keeper of the prison trusted him so much he didn't even check on his work.
    + Whatever Joseph did, the Lord caused it to succeed.

Application:

- Being a servant of God doesn't always mean you get immediate justice, but it does mean you will never be separated from the love of God.
- Joseph was thrown into prison for doing the right thing and he wasn't immediately vindicated.
- But the text tells us God "showed him steadfast love" while he was in prison.
- Being in God's love doesn't mean you will never be treated unfairly, it means God will never forsake you, even when you are mistreated by a sinful world.